would change the direction of the splits for `C` and all of its subtree, as shown in figure 9.17.

Listing 9.7 The findMin method

```
function findMin(node,
coordinateIndex)                                          #1
  if node == null
then                                                          #2
    return null
  elsif node.level == coordinateIndex
then                                        #3
    if node.left == null
then                                                  #4
      return node

else
           #5
      return findMin(node.left, coordinateIndex)
  else
    leftMin ← findMinNode(node.left,
coordinateIndex)                             #6
    rightMin ← findMinNode(node.right,
coordinateIndex)                            #7
    return min(node, leftMin,
rightMin)                                          #8
```

#1 Find the node in the tree with the minimum value for the coordinate at a given index.
#2 If node is `null`, we are traversing an empty tree, so there is no min.
#3 Lucky case: the coordinate to use for comparison is the same one for which we are looking for the minimum value, so the minimum will either be…
#4 … this very node, if its left subtree is empty…